



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Ancient Paths Christian & Classical Academy

School Website: <https://ancientpathsclassicalacademy.com>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Ancient Paths Christian Classical Academy (Columbus, OH 43228) presents a distinctly Christian, classical framework that foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and the liberal arts within a Biblically rooted worldview. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, classical approach, partnership with families, and a commitment to Western civilization through the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; with Latin, literature, history, and the other Trivium/Quadrivium components). The school explicitly identifies its mission as educating in excellence, equipping students to engage the world, and empowering them to endure in faith (Colossians 3:23; Matthew 28:18-20; Proverbs 22:6; Jeremiah 6:16). This combination signals a robust Classical orientation with clear religious foundations and parent partnership.

Overall, the school demonstrates a strong Classical frame in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goals, and Parent Community, while its public materials show solid alignment with core Classical content (liberal arts, Latin, literature, history) and a Biblically anchored formation. However, some pillars of a full classical program—notably explicit references to Great Books/Great Conversation, and detailed Socratic pedagogy/seminar practices for the upper grades—are less directly evidenced in the available materials. Taken together, Ancient Paths aligns closely with Classical aims but does not consistently demonstrate every hallmark of a canonical “full Classical” practice in every category. Therefore, the aggregate assessment is best described as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** rather than fully **CLASSICAL**.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence centers on a Christ-centered, Biblical worldview integrated throughout instruction; theology and worship-like community life are foregrounded. The school's mission statements and doctrinal commitments strongly reflect a theological grounding and a transcendent view of truth and virtue. Positive keyword indicators (truth, virtue, theology, liturgy/worship, wisdom) appear in public materials. The Negative indicators (relativism, secular humanism) are not evident in the materials.

Why CLASSICAL: The materials clearly emphasize transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, and liturgical/community life as part of daily education.

Citations: Our mission and Biblically centered framing; Bible as truth foundation; Westminster Catechism; worship-like community language.

- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** The school explicitly states formation of virtue and wisdom as the end of education, rather than job training, and frames education as formation (not mere information). It asserts that truth, goodness, and beauty are real, knowable, and central to the educational aims.

Evidence: Mission emphasizes formation of wise, virtuous young people; explicit Biblically informed aims; emphasis on wisdom and virtue as telos.

Positive keyword indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, pursuit of true/-good/beautiful. Negative indicators: none evident in public materials.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL The curriculum is clearly built on the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; literature; history; math; sciences; fine arts). There is explicit reference to the seven liberal arts and to studying history through a classical lens. However, explicit mentions of Great Books and the Great Conversation are not evident in the materials provided, which dampens full Classical alignment in this category.

Evidence: Jr. Kindergarten–7th grade curriculum listing Bible, grammar, Latin, literature, history (American and Classical Studies), mathematics, etc.; statement of seven liberal arts and history as central.

Positive keyword indicators: Seven liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Latin; literature; history; Western civilization; sacred text; memorization of Scripture; classic curriculum language.

Negative keyword indicators: Absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references in the public materials; emphasis on Biblical/theological framing may at times limit or reinterpret some secular Great Books framing.

- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Public materials emphasize memory work (e.g., memorizing Scripture) and liturgical/contemplative elements, which aligns with classical pedagogy in part. There is less explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, debates, or the full range of upper-school rhetoric/seminars described in classical pedagogy rubrics.

Evidence: Bible memorization; teacher/memory-based approaches; lower-school activities and structured study are noted; no explicit descriptions of upper-school Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric curricula in the materials provided.

Positive keyword indicators: memory work, recitation, chanting (where referenced by the classical lexicon and supported by Bible memorization language); contemplative learning in the broader sense.

Negative keyword indicators: No explicit mention of Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or explicit upper-school rhetoric/speeches in the site copy.

- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Public-facing faculty descriptions show a headmaster with classical training and a named Christendom teacher, signaling a faculty aligned with the school's classical-Christian identity. There is less explicit articulation of the faculty as “living curriculum” or “portrait of teacher” as formal statements, though the bios convey vocational and virtue-oriented framing.

Evidence: Names and bios of Headmaster Josh Lister (classical-Christian studies) and a Christendom teacher; staff page content indicating a Christian, classical formation orientation.

Positive keyword indicators: model teachers/mentors; living curriculum language appears in classical education discourse (though not always explicit on the site); collegial/moral formation language is present in values and mission.

Negative keyword indicators: absence of a formally stated “portrait of a teacher” or explicit living-curriculum description on the site copy; limited evidence for a fully developed “faculty as living curriculum” claim in public materials.

- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL The school emphasizes partnership with families, parent involvement, and parental formation with language that parents are co-teachers and engaged in a classical formation process. The site notes the importance of family partnership and independence from state funding, reinforcing a parental-centered model.

Evidence: “We partner with parents”; emphasis on parental involvement, and the belief that faith/school formation is a shared mission; ACCS accreditation and independent governance language; detailed parent

engagement through policies and admissions processes.

Positive keyword indicators: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; open campus/parent access (where stated by public materials); classical family culture.

Negative keyword indicators: none evident in public materials.

Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school aligns strongly with Classical aims in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Parents & Community, and it demonstrates robust liberal-arts curriculum and biblically integrated formation. However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and fully articulated Socratic pedagogy (especially in upper grades) are not clearly evidenced in the public site texts. The faculty portrayal is present but not fully developed as a “living curriculum” framework in the public materials. Taken as a whole, the school is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong Christian formation and classical content, but not a complete, canonically explicit Classical model across all six categories.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum (Element 3): Publicly articulate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components and a defined list of primary canonical works. Include reference to classical texts alongside Bible and Latin, and show cross-disciplinary integration demonstrating the unity of truth across disciplines.
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Add explicit documentation of Socratic/ Seminar-based learning in upper grades, Paideia-style seminars, and structured rhetoric/debate opportunities to demonstrate a full upper-school classical pedagogy.
- Faculty (Element 5): Develop and publish a clear “living-curriculum” profile for teachers, including mentor-model practices, ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy, and a public statement of teacher-student relationships as the core of the curriculum.
- Liturgical/Communal Practice (Element 1): If not already explicit, provide publicly accessible descriptions of liturgical cycles, prayer life, and communal worship or liturgical practices to strengthen the religious-metaphysical foundation and communal identity.
- General Public Narrative (Cross-cutting): Highlight Great Books, historical canon, and classical virtues in marketing materials and school communications to strengthen the perception and articulation of a fully classical program.

ABSTRACT

Ancient Paths Christian Classical Academy demonstrates a clear Classical-Christian orientation with strong religious foundations and a robust liberal-arts curriculum framed within a Biblically grounded formation. The school emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and a canonical Western educational heritage, while stressing parent partnership and independence from state education. The six-category assessment finds the school CLASSICAL in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Parents & Community; SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Faculty. The aggregate stance is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting strong classical elements but with room for more explicit Great Books/Conversations, Socratic pedagogy, and a more formalized “living curriculum” portrayal of faculty. The school’s public materials substantiate a culturally coherent Classical-Christian program that centers faith, virtue, and the liberal arts as a coherent pathway for forming wise, virtuous, and eloquent students.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission statements emphasize a distinctly Christ-centered and Classical context for education.

- The Bible is presented as the primary source of truth and instruction in all matters of faith and life; theology and catechetical content are integrated into instruction.
- Public materials reference liturgical/community life and a Biblically grounded worldview across the curriculum, including memorization of Scripture and catechetical elements.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: truth, virtue, theology, worship, wisdom, sacred/Scripture, catechesis, devotion to God, Christian worldview.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials.
- Why This Rating
- The school presents a robust theological and metaphysical foundation with explicit Bible-centered instruction and a Christian community ethos. The alignment with classical religious foundations and worship-oriented communal life supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission centers on forming virtue and wisdom, not merely workforce preparation; education is formation, not information.
- Emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable; aim toward human flourishing through classical formation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/good/beauty.
- Negative keywords: none evident.
- Why This Rating
- The program articulates formation and virtue as educative aims consistent with classical pedagogy, placing it solidly in CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curriculum pages list Jr. Kindergarten through 7th grade offerings (Bible, grammar, Latin, literature, history, etc.) and explicitly reference the seven liberal arts and Western civilization.
- The school explicitly places the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium within its framework, and emphasizes Latin and classical studies.
- Historical and literary content is framed as American and Classical Studies, indicating a classical historical orientation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: seven liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Quadrivium, Latin, literature, history (American and Classical Studies), Western civilization.
- Negative keywords: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references in public materials; emphasis on Biblical worldview may limit secular canonical references.
- Why This Rating

- The curriculum strongly reflects classical content (liberal arts, Latin, history, literature) but lacks explicit, public-facing Great Books/Great Conversation framing. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize Scripture memorization and structured, formation-focused learning, consistent with classical pedagogy's memory and recitation elements.
- Lower-school practices reflect routines and memory-based activities; upper-school pedagogy details (Socratic seminars, debates) are not clearly described in the site copy.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: memory work, recitation, contemplative learning, scholé-style restfulness (as implied by formation language in primary materials), liturgical/catechetical integration.
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit reference to Socratic seminars, Paideia style seminars, or explicit upper-school rhetoric/debate practices on the public site.
- Why This Rating
- The pedagogy evidenced aligns with memory-focused and contemplative elements typical of classical education, but explicit higher-level classical pedagogy (Socratic discourse, seminars) is not clearly documented in public-facing materials. RESULT: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe a Headmaster with classical-Christian credentials and a named Christendom teacher; staff bios reflect a theologically rooted, classical orientation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors; living curriculum (implied through mission statements and staff roles); collegial culture (implied by values).
- Negative keywords present: absence of explicit public articulation of a formal "portrait of a teacher" or a published "living curriculum" framework.
- Why This Rating
- The faculty is clearly oriented toward a classical-Christian identity; however, the public articulation of faculty as the "living curriculum" and a formal faculty development framework is not fully explicit. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental engagement, including the concept of parents as co-teachers and active involvement in the educational formation of their children.
- Public materials discuss independence from state funding and a commitment to parent formation through school processes and communications.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus/-parent involvement (as implied by access and engagement language), community formation.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.
- Why This Rating
- The school presents a strong, explicit model of parent partnership and community involvement, consistent with classical education norms in the parent/community dimension.

What Would Move the Needle

- To fully realize CLASSICAL status across all six categories, the school could:
- Curriculum (Element 3): Publicly articulate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation sequencing and canonical readings to complement Biblical/Western civilizational studies.
- Pedagogy (Element 4): Add explicit documentation of upper-grade Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussion, and formal rhetoric/debate opportunities to align with classical pedagogy expectations.
- Faculty (Element 5): Publish a formal “portrait of the teacher” and a defined living-curriculum framework, including ongoing faculty development in classical pedagogy and mentoring models.
- Religious/Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1): Provide more explicit description of liturgical or communal practices (liturgical year, worship patterns, and regular communal rites) to strengthen liturgical foundations.
- Broadened public articulation of Great Books or primary-source study within the curriculum to reinforce the canonical dimension of classical education.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.